

ACME TECHNOLOGIES

Company Policy Handbook

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy handbook establishes general workplace rules for employees, contractors, and interns of ACME Technologies. The policies apply to employees working from company offices, approved remote locations, and customer sites. Where a local law or employment agreement provides a greater legal entitlement, the applicable law or agreement takes precedence.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard working schedule is Monday through Friday, with normal core hours from 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM local time. Employees may have different schedules when required by their project, customer, or manager. Employees are expected to be available during agreed working hours and to communicate planned absences before the start of the workday.

For remote work, employees must maintain a suitable working environment, remain reachable through approved communication tools, and follow the same attendance and performance expectations that apply in the office.

3. Leave Policy

Employees should request planned leave through the company's leave-management system at least three working days in advance when practical. Manager approval is required before planned leave is taken. Emergency or sick leave should be reported to the manager as soon as reasonably possible.

Annual leave entitlement is 18 working days per calendar year for full-time employees. Unused annual leave may be carried forward for up to 10 working days, subject to applicable law and company rules. Carry-forward leave that exceeds the permitted limit may expire at the end of the following calendar year.

4. Flexible and Remote Work

Eligible employees may work remotely for up to three days per week with manager approval. Employees must protect confidential information, use approved company devices or security controls, and attend required meetings. Remote work is a working arrangement rather than an entitlement and may be changed based on business requirements.

5. Employee Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for performing assigned duties professionally, meeting agreed deadlines, protecting company property, and complying with applicable security, privacy, and conduct requirements. Questions about policy interpretation should be directed to Human Resources.

6. Information Security

Company information must be accessed only for legitimate business purposes. Employees must use strong passwords, multi-factor authentication where provided, and approved applications for business data. Passwords and authentication codes must never be shared.

Employees must report suspected phishing messages, lost devices, accidental disclosure of information, or other security incidents to the IT Security Team immediately. Security incidents should not be investigated independently when doing so could destroy evidence or increase risk.

7. Data Classification

ACME classifies information into four categories: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Public information may be shared externally after normal business review. Internal information is intended for employees and approved contractors. Confidential information includes business plans, customer information, source code, and financial forecasts. Restricted information includes highly sensitive personal, security, or regulated data and requires additional controls.

Confidential and Restricted information must not be stored in personal cloud drives, personal email accounts, or unapproved AI tools. Employees must verify recipients before sending sensitive information and should use approved encryption mechanisms when required.

8. Acceptable Use of Technology

Company devices, networks, software licenses, and accounts are provided primarily for business purposes. Reasonable personal use is permitted when it does not interfere with work, create security risks, violate law, or consume excessive company resources.

Employees may not install unauthorized software, disable security controls, use company systems to distribute malicious content, or attempt to access systems or data without authorization. Company systems may be monitored in accordance with applicable law and company procedures.

9. Artificial Intelligence and Generative AI

Employees may use company-approved AI tools to improve productivity, draft content, summarize non-sensitive information, or assist with software development. Confidential, Restricted, customer-provided, or personally identifiable information must not be entered into an AI service unless the service has been approved for that data classification.

AI-generated output must be reviewed by an employee before it is used for business decisions, customer communications, production code, or published material. Employees remain accountable for the accuracy, security, licensing, and appropriateness of AI-assisted work.

10. Code and Intellectual Property

Source code, designs, documentation, inventions, and other work products created within the scope of employment belong to ACME to the extent permitted by applicable law and contractual agreements. Employees must use approved repositories and follow project-specific branching, review, and release procedures.

11. Workplace Conduct

ACME expects employees to treat colleagues, customers, suppliers, and visitors with professionalism and respect. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, threats, retaliation, and abusive behavior are prohibited.

Employees should raise workplace concerns through their manager, Human Resources, Ethics channel, or another approved reporting route. Reports made in good faith will be handled as confidentially as practical and retaliation for a good-faith report is prohibited.

12. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations in which personal interests could improperly influence business decisions. Potential conflicts include financial interests in suppliers, accepting inappropriate gifts, outside employment that interferes with company duties, or participating in decisions involving close personal relationships.

Employees must disclose potential conflicts to their manager or Human Resources. The company will determine appropriate mitigation, which may include recusal from a decision, reassignment of duties, or other controls.

13. Gifts and Business Hospitality

Employees may accept modest business hospitality when it is lawful, infrequent, transparent, and does not influence or appear to influence a business decision. Cash and cash equivalents must not be accepted from customers, suppliers, or prospective business partners.

14. Expense and Travel

Business expenses must be reasonable, necessary, and supported by receipts or other required documentation. Employees should submit expense reports within 15 calendar days after returning from business travel. Travel arrangements should normally be made through the company's approved travel provider.

15. Policy Violations

Violations of company policy may result in corrective action, up to and including termination of employment, subject to applicable law and contractual obligations. The appropriate response depends on the seriousness, frequency, impact, and circumstances of the violation.

16. Quick Reference

Topic	Key Rule
Annual leave	18 working days per year; up to 10 days may be carried forward.
Remote work	Up to 3 days per week for eligible employees with manager approval.
Core hours	10:00 AM–5:00 PM local time, unless a different schedule is approved.
Security incidents	Report suspected incidents to IT Security immediately.
Confidential data	Do not place it in personal drives, personal email, or unapproved AI tools.
AI usage	Use approved tools and review AI-generated output before business use.
Expenses	Submit expense reports within 15 calendar days after business travel.

Document Control

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This fictional document is created for RAG practice. It contains deliberately searchable facts, including numbers, dates, roles, restrictions, and policy exceptions.